minicut Video Editor

Embedded LuaJIT & Plugin API Reference Manual

LuaJIT 5.1 Runtime Dockable Tool Panels Tool Shelf Dock Built-in Network (libcurl)

1. Introduction & Architecture

minicut features a fully embedded, high-performance **LuaJIT** scripting engine. minicut enables automation, timeline editing, clip keyframing, and custom interactive dockable tool panels.

Script Directory Locations

Scripts and icons are discovered in the user's home configuration directory:

Location	Trigger / Role	Description
`~/.config/minicut/autorun/`	Startup / Auto-register	Scripts execute on startup and generate an icon button on the horizontal Tool Shelf Dock below the main menu bar.
`~/.config/minicut/scripts/`	Menu Click / On Demand	Scripts appear in the top-level **Scripts** menu on the main menu bar. Clicking runs the script and opens its tool panel.
`~/.config/`	Shelf Icon Asset	32x32 PNG icon images matching script stems (e.g., `quick_placement.png` for `quick_placement.lua`).

Location	Trigger / Role	Description

`minicut/icons/`

> **Tool Shelf Fallback Badges**

> If an autorun script does not have a corresponding PNG icon in `~/.config/minicut/icons/`,
> minicut automatically creates a sleek 2-letter uppercase badge (e.g., `QP` for Quick Placement)
> on the shelf button.

2. Plugin Script Architecture

Every minicut script follows an intuitive, modular structure. A script defines timeline and clip manipulation callbacks, followed by a `plugin:init_panel()` method that registers Dear ImGui UI controls.

```
-- ============================================================================

-- Example Base Script: my_tool.lua

-- ============================================================================



local target_track = 0

local clip_scale = 1.25



-- Timeline and clip manipulation logic

function execute_placement()

    minicut.push_undo()

    local path = "/path/to/media.mp4"

    local clip_id = timeline.place_clip(path, target_track, timeline.get_playhead(),
5.0)

    if clip_id then
```

```
        clip.set_scale(clip_id, clip_scale)

        minicut.set_status("Placed media clip on track " .. target_track)

    end

end



-- GUI panel declaration

function plugin:init_panel()

    gui.text("Media Placement Tool")

    gui.separator()

    target_track = gui.slider_int("Track Lane", target_track, 0, 4)

    clip_scale = gui.slider_float("Initial Scale", clip_scale, 0.1, 5.0)



    if gui.button("Place Clip At Playhead", execute_placement) then

        -- Optional inline handling

    end

end
```

When executed, each script automatically opens an independent, dockable tool panel situated to the right of the preview and timeline panels.

3. Core Lua Modules

3.1. Project & File Automation (`project` / Global)

Function	Returns	Description
`project_save([path])` `project.save([path])`	`boolean, string`	Saves current project state to a `.minicut` JSON file. If path is omitted, saves to the current project

Function	Returns	Description
		file path.
`project_load(path)` `project.load(path)`	`boolean, string`	Loads a project from `path`, updates timeline, resets playhead, and refreshes the audio engine and video preview.
`project.get_name()`	`string`	Returns the current project name.
`project.set_name(name)`	`void`	Sets the current project name.
`project.import_video(path)`	`string (asset_id)`	Imports a video file into the project's media asset pool.
`project.import_audio(path)`	`string (asset_id)`	Imports an audio file into the project's asset pool.
`project.import_image(path, [dur])`	`string (asset_id)`	Imports a static image file into the project's asset pool (default duration: 5.0s).

3.2. Network & Internet Library (`net`)

Powered by embedded **libcurl**, the `net` module enables downloading remote media, uploading exports to web servers, and calling REST APIs.

Function	Returns	Description
`net.get(url, [opts])`	`table	(nil, err)`	Sends an HTTP GET request. Returns table: `{ status, ok, body, headers }`.
`net.post(url, body, [opts])`	`table	(nil, err)`	Sends an HTTP POST request with string or key-value table body.
`net.download(url, dest, [opts])`	`boolean, string`	Streams remote file directly to disk at `dest` without RAM overhead.
`net.upload(url, file, [opts])`	`table	(nil, err)`	Uploads local file via multipart/form-data. Supports

Function	Returns	Description
		custom `field_name` and `extra_fields`.
`net.request(opts)`	`table | (nil, err)`	Generic HTTP request with custom method (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE, PATCH).

```
-- Example: Downloading stock music and importing directly to timeline

local ok, path = net.download("https://example.com/soundtrack.mp3",
"/tmp/soundtrack.mp3")

if ok then

    local clip_id = timeline.place_clip(path, 1, 0.0, 30.0)

    minicut.set_status("Downloaded and placed soundtrack!")

end
```

3.3. GUI Controls (`gui`)

Function	Returns	Description
`gui.button(label, [callback])`	`boolean`	Standard push button. Invokes `callback` when clicked.
`gui.small_button(label, [cb])`	`boolean`	Compact button without vertical frame padding.
`gui.text(text)`	`void`	Standard text label.
`gui.text_colored(text, r, g, b, [a])`	`void`	Colored text label (color components 0.0 to 1.0).
`gui.text_disabled(text)`	`void`	Muted gray text label.
`gui.separator()`	`void`	Horizontal dividing line.
`gui.same_line([offset], [spacing])`	`void`	Places the next control on the same

Function	Returns	Description
		horizontal line.
`gui.slider_float(lbl, val, min, max)`	`number`	Interactive floating-point horizontal slider.
`gui.slider_int(lbl, val, min, max)`	`integer`	Interactive integer horizontal slider.
`gui.drag_float(lbl, val, [spd, min, max])`	`number`	Click-and-drag floating-point number field.
`gui.checkbox(lbl, val)`	`boolean`	Toggle checkbox.
`gui.input_text(lbl, val)`	`string`	Single-line text input field.
`gui.progress_bar(fraction, [text])`	`void`	Progress bar (0.0 to 1.0).
`gui.tooltip(text)`	`void`	Displays hover tooltip over preceding item.

3.4. Timeline & Tracks (`timeline`)

Function	Returns	Description
`timeline.place_clip(path, track, t, dur)`	`string (clip_id)`	Imports media and places clip onto track lane at timestamp `t`.
`timeline.get_playhead()`	`number`	Returns current playhead time in seconds.
`timeline.set_playhead(time_sec)`	`void`	Seeks playhead to specified time and updates video/audio preview.
`timeline.get_duration()`	`number`	Returns total project duration in seconds.
`timeline.get_track_count()`	`integer`	Returns total number of timeline tracks.
`timeline.get_track_depth(track_i`	`integer`	Returns Z-depth compositing order for

Function	Returns	Description
`dx)`		track (0=back, 100=front).
`timeline.set_track_depth(track_idx, z)`	`void`	Sets Z-depth compositing order for track.
`timeline.add_track(track_type)`	`string (id)`	Appends a new track (`"video"` or `"audio"`).
`timeline.delete_clip(clip_id)`	`boolean`	Deletes clip from timeline.
`timeline.split_clip(clip_id, split_t)`	`boolean`	Splits clip into two halves at timestamp `split_t`.

3.5. Clip Transforms & Keyframes (`clip` & `timeline`)

Function	Returns	Description
`clip.get_selected_id()`	`string`	Returns ID of currently selected clip.
`clip.get_position(clip_id)`	`x, y`	Returns clip pixel translation offsets.
`clip.set_position(clip_id, x, y)`	`void`	Sets clip translation offsets.
`clip.get_scale(clip_id)`	`number`	Returns scale multiplier (default 1.0).
`clip.set_scale(clip_id, scale)`	`void`	Sets clip scale multiplier.
`clip.get_rotation(clip_id)`	`number`	Returns rotation angle in degrees.
`clip.set_rotation(clip_id, deg)`	`void`	Sets rotation angle in degrees.
`clip.get_opacity(clip_id)`	`number`	Returns opacity (0.0=invisible, 1.0=solid).
`clip.set_opacity(clip_id, alpha)`	`void`	Sets clip opacity.
`clip.get_volume(clip_id)`	`numbe`	Returns audio gain (1.0 = 100%).

Function	Returns	Description
	`r`	
`clip.set_volume(clip_id, vol)`	`void`	Sets audio gain.
`timeline.add_keyframe(id, prop, t, val)`	`void`	Adds animation keyframe (prop: `"pos_x"`, `"pos_y"`, `"scale"`, `"rotation"`, `"opacity"`, `"volume"`).
`timeline.evaluate_keyframe(id, prop, t, def)`	`numbe r`	Evaluates interpolated value at timestamp `t`.

3.6. Engine Utilities (`minicut`)

Function	Returns	Description
`minicut.push_undo()`	`void`	Pushes the current project snapshot onto the Undo stack.
`minicut.set_status(msg, [dur])`	`void`	Displays green notification toast in the main menu bar.
`minicut.log(message)`	`void`	Logs message to the console standard output.

4. Comprehensive Plugin Examples

Example 1: Keyframe Bouncing Logo Animator

```
-- ~/.config/minicut/autorun/logo_bounce.lua

local bounce_dur = 2.0

local peak_height = -150.0



function apply_bounce_animation()
```

```
    local cid = clip.get_selected_id()
    if cid == "" then
        minicut.set_status("Please select a clip first!")
        return
    end

    minicut.push_undo()
    local cur_t = timeline.get_playhead()
    timeline.clear_keyframes(cid, "pos_y")

    -- Animate bounce cycle
    timeline.add_keyframe(cid, "pos_y", cur_t, 0.0)
    timeline.add_keyframe(cid, "pos_y", cur_t + (bounce_dur * 0.5), peak_height)
    timeline.add_keyframe(cid, "pos_y", cur_t + bounce_dur, 0.0)

    minicut.set_status("Applied bounce keyframes to clip!")
end

function plugin:init_panel()
    gui.text("Bouncing Logo Animator")
    gui.separator()
    bounce_dur = gui.slider_float("Cycle Duration (s)", bounce_dur, 0.2, 5.0)
    peak_height = gui.slider_float("Peak Jump (px)", peak_height, -400.0, 0.0)
    gui.button("Apply Bounce Animation", apply_bounce_animation)
```

```
end
```

Example 2: Automated Cloud Project Backup

```
-- ~/.config/minicut/scripts/cloud_backup.lua

local upload_endpoint = "https://httpbin.org/post"



function execute_backup()

    local temp_file = "/tmp/minicut_auto_backup.minicut"

    local save_ok, err = project_save(temp_file)

    if not save_ok then

        minicut.set_status("Failed to save local snapshot: " .. tostring(err))

        return

    end



    minicut.set_status("Uploading project backup...")

    local resp = net.upload(upload_endpoint, temp_file, {

        field_name = "project_file",

        extra_fields = {

            timestamp = tostring(os.time()),

            project_name = project.get_name()

        }

    })



    if resp and resp.ok then

        minicut.set_status("Project successfully backed up to cloud!")
```

```
    else

        minicut.set_status("Backup upload failed: " .. tostring(resp and resp.status or
"network error"))

    end

end



function plugin:init_panel()

    gui.text("Cloud Project Backup Tool")

    gui.separator()

    upload_endpoint = gui.input_text("Endpoint URL", upload_endpoint)

    gui.button("Backup Project Now", execute_backup)

end
```